Historical Background

"The Catholic Distortion"

A. Rome's Sacred-Secular Schema
   1. "Sacred" callings vs. Everything else
   2. or, "Spiritual estate" *vs.* "Temporal estate"

B. Protestant Reformation
   1. Luther, Calvin: The "priesthood of all believers"
   2. Our need: debunk an exaggerated dualism that scorns the common, daily life

"The Protestant Distortion"

A. The lost meaning of "vocation" & "calling"
   1. Vocation/Calling have become "work" & "job"
   2. The "Protestant work ethic" has descended

B. Industrial Revolution
   1. Work made Sacred

      Coolidge: "The man who builds a factory builds a temple and he who works there worships there."

      Henry Ford: "Work is the salvation of the human race, morally, physically, socially."
   2. Calling made Secular

      Max Weber, The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism
   3. Our need: debunk calling without a caller

Protestant Reformation

A. Answers Rome with "Priesthood of all Believers"
   1. Luther, Calvin: "priesthood of all believers" (1Pet 2.9); "everything is good" (1Tim 4.4)
   2. Puritans

B. Main ideas in Priesthood of all Believers
   1. Primarily related to the Church (e.g, direct access to Christ; *communion of saints*)
   2. Vocation - Rom 12.2

Biblical Foundations

"Call" in Scripture

A. Different Meanings
   1. To *catch someone's ear*; to *name* (Gen 2.19,23) to *save* or *deliver* (Rom 8.30)
   2. Our duties in light of Christ's mercy, Lordship & glory (Rom 12.1-2; 1Cor 7.17,20-22)

B. Our Callings
   1. **Primary** Calling: What we are called to as disciples (1Cor 10.31; Col 3.17,23; Eph 6.5f)
   2. **Secondary** Calling: What we are called to *individually* & *uniquely*

      1Cor 7.20 (17,24): … *each one should retain the place in life that the Lord assigned to him and to which God has called him*

C. 1Corinthians 7
   1. 1Cor 7.17-24 – Callings in relation to our (present) places & circumstances
      a. "staying where your are"
      b. The value of "voluntary Christians"
   2. 1Cor 7.29-31 – Callings in relation to our (future) heavenly calling
      a. In light of the times
      b. The perspective of eternity

Distinctions

A. Spiritual & Sacred

B Vocation *vs.* Occupation

C Christ is our Identity, not our "Calling" (Rom 12.2; Eph 4.23; Col 3.10; Heb 12.2)

Implications

Ethics & Integrity

A Ethics
   1. The World's way *vs.* Christian's way (Rom 12.2)
   2. Restrains ambition, yet sustains drive

B. Identity: *"In the world… but not of the world"* (Jn 17; Heb 11- pilgrims)
   1. Although *earthly* pilgrims… we are a Heavenly & Holy people
   2. We do *not* love the World (1Jn 3.15-17; Jam 4.4)
      a. We do love the World as "Good Samaritans" (Jn 3.11-21; Titus 3.1,2)
      b. World does *not* love us (Jn 15.18; 16.4)

C. Salt & Light

Mt 5.13-16: let your light shine before men…

1Peter 2.12: Live such good lives among the pagans that, though they accuse you of doing wrong, they may see your good deeds and glorify God on the day he visits us.

1. We must *be* "salt" & "light" to have the effect of salt & light
2. We must be *in* the world… to have effect
3. We must not just talk (1Pet 3.1)

Time of Opportunity

A. Failures of Modernity: Impersonal & Dehumanizing

B. Plausibility of Meaning, Truth & Love

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